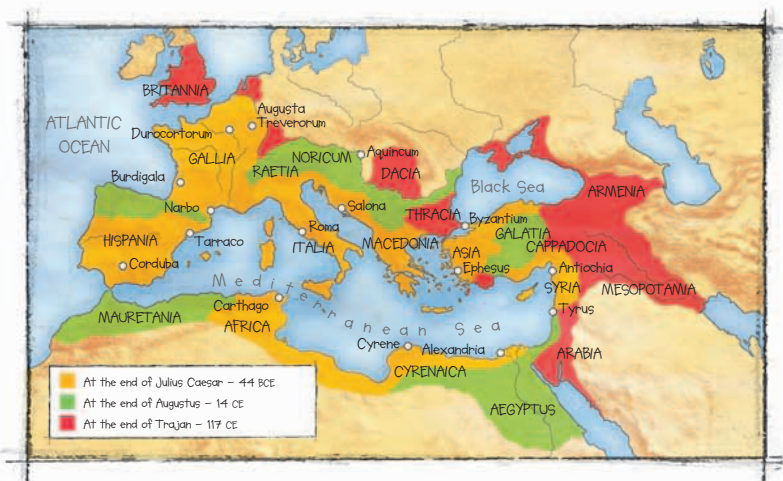




The empire builders

By Julius Caesar's death in 44 BCE, the Roman Empire covered most of the Mediterranean, France, and some of Spain. **Augustus made it much bigger**, and, by 14 CE, he had added Egypt, the rest of Spain, and large parts of central Europe. He tried to **invade Germany**, but was met by barbarian hordes and it turned out to be a disaster. The empire reached its peak under **EMPEROR TRAJAN** in 117 CE.

By the way...

my real name is Gaius Octavius, but I changed it to Augustus Caesar. All future emperors would be known as "Caesar," or "Augustus."

Remodeling Rome

After decades of civil war, **Rome was a mess**, so Augustus set about rebuilding it. He built many new temples, including the famous "**PANTHEON**" (pictured right), and rebuilt almost every major building in Rome. He also restored the city's **sewer and water systems**.



The greatest emperor

Many consider Augustus to be Rome's greatest emperor. He reformed the Roman tax system, developed networks of roads with an efficient postal service, and created police and fire-fighting services. His reign laid the foundations for an empire that lasted for 1,500 years.

The great general **JULIUS CAESAR** (100–44 BCE) set the wheels in motion for the end of the Roman Republic by becoming **DICTATOR**.

MARK ANTONY (83–30 BCE) HELPED **AUGUSTUS** WIN THE **CIVIL WAR** against Julius Caesar's assassins, Brutus and Cassius.